

history and that was free for all to see. Satoshi's choice first to employ this functionality by inscribing a note about bank bailouts made it clear he was keen on never letting us forget the failings of the 2008 financial crisis.

AN ALTERNATIVE FINANCIAL SYSTEM

Nine days after this poignant inscription, the first ever transaction using bitcoin took place between Satoshi Nakamoto and Hal Finney, an early advocate and Bitcoin developer. Nine months later the first exchange rate would be set for bitcoin, valuing it at eight one-hundredths of a cent per coin, or 1,309 bitcoin to the dollar.²⁹ A dollar invested then would be worth over \$1 million by the start of 2017, underscoring the viral growth that the innovation was poised to enjoy.

Diving deeper into Satoshi's writings around the time, it becomes more apparent that he was fixated on providing an alternative financial system, if not a replacement entirely. After the network had been up and running for over a month, Satoshi wrote of Bitcoin, "It's completely decentralized, with no central server or trusted parties, because everything is based on crypto proof instead of trust ... I think this is the first time we're trying a decentralized, non-trust-based system."³⁰

On December 5, 2010, Satoshi showed an unnervingly human side, pleading that WikiLeaks not accept bitcoin as a means of payment after major credit card networks had